The Phenomenon of the World: Matter and Thought

A Working Paper on Distinction

Serge Magomet (Aimate)
Independent Researcher
Ontology Lab

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Abstract

The paper develops the implications of the ontology of fixation formulated in *The Phenomenon of the World*. The paper shows that the division of objects into material and ideal has no ontological basis: category membership is not a property of the object as such but rather the result of an operation in which the object becomes determinate. This yields the thesis that the ontological barrier between matter and thought cannot be fixed as a boundary: not in the sense of "there is a connection" but in the sense of "nothing makes connection impossible in principle." The second thesis is a lexical consequence of the first: the words "matter" and "idea" do not denote two substances. Both theses are supported by conceptual analysis (belonging cannot be a property without presupposing what it is supposed to determine), by their consistency with the perplexity at the boundaries of quantum mechanics and cosmology (whose structure is that of a limit, not of ignorance: the rules of the regime do not indicate a method of solution, and this has the same structure as the suspension of container logic), and by an internal analysis grounded in the ontology of fixation. The paper does not claim to solve the mind–body problem; it changes the formulation: instead of "how does matter produce thought," it asks "in what operations is the boundary between them established, and where does it cease to work." The concepts of "matter" and "idea" remain indeterminate in a positive sense: they have yet to be redefined through a description of operations rather than through positing substances.

Keywords: fixation, ontological barrier, matter, idea, mind–body problem, qualia, boundary, limit, blind spot, container logic, quantum mechanics, cosmology, double fixation

Author's Note: This paper is the second part of a program begun in *The Phenomenon of the World*. It applies the ontology of fixation introduced there to the mind–body problem and deliberately confines itself to a negative result: the suspension of a mistaken formulation of the question. The positive description of the operations in which "the material" and "the ideal" acquire determinateness will be the subject of the next part. The text can be read without prior familiarity with the first work: key concepts are defined as the exposition proceeds, and references

to *The Phenomenon of the World* are provided for readers acquainted with the previous work. But its result is a suspension, not a replacement—and this is not a gap but the stated scope of this step. The main text deliberately avoids a literature review and positioning; the present note serves only to orient readers. While this framework resonates with certain strands of process philosophy, late Wittgensteinian grammar, and speculative realism's rejection of correlationism, it deliberately avoids a detailed literature review. This is a methodological choice: the text aims to unfold the concept of "fixation" from its own internal operational logic, rather than defining it primarily through contrast with predecessors. Where terminology overlaps with tradition (e.g., "blind spot," "regime"), it is strictly redefined within the proposed operational framework.

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1 Thesis 1. The Barrier between Matter and Thought

The rejection of classifying objects by worlds is not a methodological quirk but a consequence of what was established in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§3–§4). From this consequence there follows a minimal but strong claim: there is no impermeable barrier between matter and thought: the ontological barrier cannot be fixed as a boundary. Not "there is a connection" but "nothing makes connection impossible in principle."

1.1 What is suspended

We are no longer engaged in assigning known objects and phenomena among worlds—"which belongs where." This is not a rejection of distinction as such but of a specific procedure: assigning an object a "residence permit" in a world as its own property.

Why it is suspended: the distinction between the ontology of the world and the procedure of belonging (§3) established that belonging does not precede fixation. An object does not "sit" in a world; it becomes determinate by being fixed in one regime or another. Consequently, the question "to which world does an object belong" has no answer to be found in the object itself. Classification is not merely incorrect; it is barren: it creates the illusion of an answer and blocks the real question.

1.2 What "contains all worlds and all objects" means

The claim that something contains all worlds and all objects is readily read as a return to container logic: as if there were a largest vessel containing all worlds and objects. This is exactly the logic we rejected in §1, and for this very reason "contains" here requires clarification.

"Contains" does not mean "houses" but "is the condition of possibility." There is no world and no object that would be outside—not because it has "absorbed" them but because there is nothing that could stand opposed to "outside": any fixation, any world, and any object arise within it as within a field, not as within a vessel.

"Non-closure" here means: there is no external boundary, no "outside" from which one could survey the whole and declare something "external." This is not infinity in a pejorative sense but

the absence of an external standpoint (cf. §9).

1.3 Why the absence of impenetrable barriers follows from this

The argument runs as follows.

Premise 1. Belonging of an object to a world is not a property of its own; it is the result of fixation (§3).

Premise 1 is not a caveat; it is proved by reductio. A property is meaningful only within a world: "to have mass" applies to physical objects, "to have income" to social ones, "to have spin"—to quantum ones. Outside a world with its rules, a property has no conditions of application. But then, to ascribe to an object the property "to belong to world X," we must already know that it belongs to X—otherwise we cannot know which properties apply to it. This yields a circle: belonging is presupposed by the definition of the property of belonging.

This circle cannot be escaped. One cannot claim: "the property of belonging is primary and does not need a world," because then it is not a property in our sense of "property": it is not ascribed within a world but precedes it. And what precedes a world cannot be its property.

Consequently, belonging cannot be a property of an object. It is what makes the ascription of properties possible—a condition, not a property.

Premise 2. Boundaries between worlds are established in fixation, not "in nature as such"; they are operational rather than ontological (§4).

Premise 3. A boundary that is not established in any operation is not a boundary: it neither separates nor connects. This is not a stipulation about word usage: this is how the boundary is understood in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§1–§6), where it is defined as an internal condition rather than an external wall.

Premise 3 is not an arbitrary stipulation. Its basis is operational: a boundary that is not established in any operation cannot be indicated, crossed, or revised. It fulfills none of the functions that make a boundary a boundary: it does not separate, connect, or set conditions of transition. The concept of a boundary stripped of all these functions is empty: it designates nothing that could function in distinction. Therefore Premise 3 does not introduce a new constraint; it fixes the minimal condition under which the word "boundary" has any application.

Status caveat. Premise 3 is not a neutral analytic truth about "boundary in general." It expresses an operationalist condition accepted within the framework of the ontology of fixation: only what is established in an operation and can therefore be indicated as a condition of distinction qualifies as a boundary. This is neither an empirical generalization nor an arbitrary stipulation about the word "boundary"; it is a framework choice. The cost is that a noumenal boundary "in itself," a boundary not given in any operation, is excluded from the outset as a subject. If this choice is not accepted, the conclusion of Thesis 1 does not follow; if accepted, it follows analytically. Therefore Thesis 1 should be read as conditional in a precise sense: **within the framework of the ontology of fixation**, the ontological barrier cannot be fixed as a boundary.

A clarification is needed to forestall a natural objection: if two fixations mutually limit each other, does this not presuppose a common substrate in which the limitation takes place? No. Mutual limitation does not require a shared substance; it requires a shared boundary. Two regimes can limit each other without sharing a medium, provided the boundary between them is itself an operation rather than a thing. The limitation is not something that "happens to" a prior common ground; it is what constitutes the relation between the two fixations. To demand a common substrate is to apply the grammar of substance to what is a structural relation — the same category error identified in Premise 1.

Hence not the metaphysical claim "there is no barrier" but the weaker and more precise claim: the ontological barrier cannot be given as an object of fixation and therefore does not operate as a boundary. An objection that allows a noumenal boundary "in itself" does not refute the conclusion: it challenges not the inference but the framework adopted.

A further clarification is needed at this point, since the framework adopted here is operationalist. Fixation is not a substance, not a process in the Whiteheadian sense, and not an act of a transcendental subject. It is a structural relation: the condition under which determinacy arises within a regime. To ask "what fixes?" is to apply to a condition the grammar of an agent — the same category error identified in Premise 1. Fixation does not precede the fixed; it is the name for the relation in which the fixed acquires determinacy. This is why the framework is neither correlationist (fixation is not identified with human access) nor process-philosophical (fixation is not a flow of becoming that produces its terms): it is operational, and its ontology is the ontology of conditions, not of entities.

Consequence. The ontological barrier—a boundary not established in any operation—cannot be fixed without thereby ceasing to be ontological. To fix a boundary as non-operational is to perform an operation that establishes it; it thereby becomes operational. The concept of an ontological barrier requires an operation that cancels it. Consequently, the ontological barrier does not operate as a boundary: it neither separates nor connects; it is posited as what, by definition, cannot be given.

To say that the ontological barrier cannot be fixed as a boundary is to say that it does not exist as an object. It cannot be fixed either from within or from any other operation. The assertion "there is no barrier" does not describe the world from an external standpoint; it registers the impossibility of something's being an object of fixation. Such an assertion does not require an external standpoint: it speaks not of what lies beyond fixation but of what cannot be an object of fixation.

1.4 What this does not mean

It does not mean that matter and thought are identical.

It does not mean that one reduces to the other.

It does not mean that there is some positive connection between them (this question is deferred).

It does not mean that the boundary between them is unreal or conventional: it is real as an

operational boundary, established in fixation.

It does not mean that there are no boundaries between matter and thought. There are boundaries: they are established in operations and are permeable. What is claimed is only that these boundaries are not an ontological barrier.

A clarification is needed to remove a possible reading of the thesis as binary. A barrier is not a binary feature. Boundaries are permeable to varying degrees: they are permeable in some respects and impermeable in others, and the degree of permeability may vary. The assertion "the ontological barrier cannot be fixed as a boundary" means not "there are no boundaries at all" but rather "there is no absolute impermeability": any concrete boundary has some degree of permeability and can be re-established. Operational constraints—causality, conservation laws, thresholds of sensitivity—remain; they are precisely what make a boundary a boundary rather than a wall. For example: the boundary between the physiological and the phenomenal regimes is impermeable in one respect (pain is not transmitted to another as a quality) and permeable in another (pain is fixed as a signal in the semantic regime and as tissue damage in the physiological one). The degree of permeability is determined not by the "nature" of the boundary but rather by the set of operations in which it is established.

A clarification regarding the normative dimension: the claim that regimes are "juxtaposed, not subordinated" is an ontological statement about the absence of a foundational hierarchy, not a political claim about the equality of power or the absence of domination. The framework describes the conditions of possibility for fixation; it does not provide a normative critique of how specific fixations are enforced, institutionalized, or weaponized. Such critique is a necessary subsequent step, but it cannot be conducted until the operational structure of the boundary itself is established.

Here an objection may be raised against the very concept of fixation: if every boundary is operational and can be re-established, is "fixation" not a new substance, the only thing not subject to fixation? No. A substance is what is fixed as self-identical and independent; both self-identity and independence are results of an operation, not presuppositions of it. Consequently, the question "is fixation a substance?" applies to an operation a category that the operation itself produces. This is the same error as in the proof of Premise 1: one cannot characterize an operation by a category that arises only through it. For the same reason fixation cannot be "everything": idealism requires that fixation be a substance, but it names an operation, not a thing. The boundary between fixation and the fixed is not an ontological boundary between two things but the structure of a description, having two sides: what is set and how it is set (cf. §9).

The functional distinction between fixation and substance lies in self-applicability: a substance claims self-grounding and cannot be described by the means it itself produces; fixation acknowledges that it is itself constituted within a regime and that it has a limit. A substance is closed; fixation is Gödel-like (§10 of *The Phenomenon of the World*). This is not a metaphor but a structural distinction: a closed system cannot indicate its own limit; a system that acknowledges a limit is not closed and therefore not a substance.

At the same time, the thesis may seem underdetermined: it says what is not and is silent about

what is. But choosing between positive answers itself belongs to the type of procedure that the thesis suspends: any such answer presupposes that behind the words "matter" and "idea" there is something standing that another "something" could replace. The thesis suspends not the answer but the question's formulation: not "what is there instead of matter and idea" but "in what operations do these words acquire meaning." Underdetermination here is not a gap but a consequence: the thesis does not choose between positive answers because choosing between them presupposes the ontology that the thesis has suspended. A positive description is the task of the next step, not a gap in the thesis.

Thus the claim is strictly minimal: the ontological barrier cannot be fixed as a boundary. Everything beyond this requires a separate step, not taken here.

1.5 What this changes

The question of the mind–body problem shifts. Instead of "how does matter produce thought" or "how does thought act on matter": the question "in what regimes and through what fixations is the boundary between them established, and where does it cease to work." This is not a solution to the problem but a change in formulation—the same change carried out in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§3–§4) for belonging in general.

This shift remains to be developed further: to describe not the "connection" of matter and thought but the operations in which the boundary between them is established and crossed. But that is the next step.

1.5.1 Sketch: qualia

First, what double fixation does not mean here. It does not mean that pain and the neural process are the same thing described in two ways. Such "one and the same" would be a third thing standing behind both fixations, and there is no such thing in our framework. Nor does it mean that pain is caused by the neural process: causality presupposes that the cause exists before the effect and independently of it, but the neural process, taken before phenomenal fixation, does not have the determinateness required for a causal link to pain.

What it does mean is this: pain and the neural process are two fixations of one operation that cannot be separated from one another. Not because a common substrate stands behind them but because they are mutually limiting: one cannot change one without changing the other, under the conditions in which both are given. This limitation is what we call "one operation." Not a thing but a relation.

A clarification that removes the reading of "one operation" as a third thing. "One operation" does not designate a third element standing behind both fixations and explaining them. It is a name for the mutual limitation taken as a whole, not for what "produces" both fixations. If both fixations are removed, "the operation" does not remain: no more than detention remains without the detainer and the detained, "one operation" does not remain without both fixations. Therefore the formula "two fixations of one operation" does not posit a hidden substrate: it says that the relation of mutual limitation is primary relative to the division into "physiological" and "phenomenal," not

that there is something third lying behind them. To make this explicit: the phrase "one operation" is a name for the mutual limitation taken as a whole. It is not a designation of a third entity that stands behind both fixations and produces them. If both fixations are removed, "the operation" does not remain — no more than "detention" remains without the detainer and the detained. The grammar of "one operation" is the grammar of a relation, not of a substance. To ask "what is this operation made of?" is to apply to a relation the grammar appropriate to a thing — the same error that produced the mind–body problem in the first place. In the case of pain and the neural process, "one operation" is fixed at the level of the living organism taken as a whole: not as an operation of "consciousness" nor as an operation of "the brain," but as an operation in which the physiological and the phenomenal are not yet distinguished. The organism here is not a subject in the phenomenological sense and not a substance in the Cartesian sense; nor is this vitalism or panpsychism. No additional entity is introduced. "Organism" names the level of description at which mutual limitation is registrable before its decomposition into two regimes — a level that precedes the distinction between "who experiences" and "what is experienced." This level is not chosen arbitrarily: it is the narrowest range in which the rules of the physiological regime (causal closure, metabolic exchange) and the rules of the phenomenal regime (first-person perspective, qualitative character) are both operative without one being reducible to the other. Below this level, phenomenal fixation has no conditions of application; above it, the first-person perspective is no longer the mode of registration. The organism is where the two regimes overlap — and this is why mutual limitation is fixed there. Specifying this level is not a positive definition; it indicates where double fixation can be described without positing a new substrate or a third thing. "Level of description" here is neither purely epistemic nor purely ontological but operational: a level is where a regime's rules apply, and it is discovered by the applicability of rules, not posited as a layer of being. Likewise, "operative" here does not mean "given to a subject": mutual limitation is registrable within a regime, not present to a consciousness. As detention is neither a physical constraint nor a normative act taken separately but their mutual limitation, so pain is neither a neural process nor a quality taken separately but their mutual limitation.

Why does phenomenal fixation have the character it has: privacy, quality, irreducibility to physiological description? Because the rules of the phenomenal regime include the first-person perspective. Pain is given as "mine," as a quality, as that which cannot be conveyed to another without remainder, not because behind it hides a mysterious substance but because such are the rules of fixation in this regime. The physiological regime has no such rules: the neural process is not given to anyone, it has no quality and is not private. These are not two objects but two regimes, and the difference between them is a difference in rules, not in substrate.

The remainder that is not translated into physiological description is not a hidden essence but the trace of a translation. Consider the conversion of a vector image into a raster: the Bézier curves do not "hide" inside the pixels; they cease to exist as vectors and leave only a raster trace. The information about the curve's mathematical continuity is not lost in the sense of being concealed somewhere in the pixel grid; it is lost in the sense of being inexpressible in the target format. The translation is irreversible, and the remainder is not a hidden substance but the structural cost of changing the format. So with pain and the neural process: the quality of pain is not "hidden" in the neurons, awaiting discovery. It is the trace of translating a physiological process

into the phenomenal regime — a translation in which certain features (first-person givenness, qualitative character, privacy) become expressible and others (spatial coordinates, causal structure, measurability) become inexpressible. The remainder is not a missing substance but the structural cost of the translation. The analogy with format conversion is an indication, not a proof: it makes the structure of translation visible but does not establish that phenomenal fixation works in precisely this way. Its task is to dispel the intuition of "hiddenness" (as if the quality of pain were concealed in the neurons and were awaiting discovery), not to replace the description of the operations of the phenomenal regime.

What this yields. The question "how does matter produce thought" is suspended: it presupposes that matter (the physiological regime) exists prior to and independently of thought (the phenomenal regime) and then produces it. But both are fixations, and the relation between them is not production but mutual limitation. The question "why there is anything it is like to be" remains. But it ceases to be a question about the gulf between two substances and becomes a question about why in this regime fixation has the rules it does.

This is a sketch, not a developed description. It shows how the mechanism of double fixation could work in the case of qualia but does not develop it fully: that would require a separate study of the operations of the phenomenal regime. Concretely: (1) a list of the rules constituting the phenomenal regime (privacy, quality, first-person perspective); (2) a description of how neural and phenomenal fixations mutually limit each other—that is, what change in one entails a change in the other; (3) a clarification of what is here called "one operation"—not as a search for a third substrate but as an indication of the level of description to which this name belongs: the operation of the organism, the operation of consciousness, or the operation of fixation as such. The clarification must show at what level mutual limitation is fixed as a whole, and must not introduce a new entity standing behind both fixations.

A final clarification on the status of what has been said. The sketch of double fixation does not solve the mind–body problem; it does not even attempt to. What it offers is a change in the formulation of the problem: from "how does matter produce thought" to "in what operations is the boundary between them established, and where does it cease to work." This is not a solution but a suspension of the question that blocked any solution. The Hard Problem, as formulated by Chalmers and others, remains untouched in its original form — but its formulation is shown to presuppose the container logic that the framework suspends. Whether this constitutes a "solution" depends on whether one accepts the framework; if one does, the Hard Problem dissolves; if one does not, the framework itself must be challenged on its own terms, not by demanding that it solve a problem it has shown to be ill-posed.

2 Thesis 2. Matter and Idea as Two Regimes of Fixation

The division of objects into material and ideal has no ontological basis. Not in the sense that "everything is material" or "everything is ideal" but in the sense that the words "matter" and "idea" themselves do not denote two different entities to which objects can be assigned. The concepts used here do not do the work for which they were intended.

2.1 What is suspended

What is suspended is not only the procedure of classification ("which object goes to which world") but the very presupposition on which it rested: as if behind the words "matter" and "idea" there were two substances, two "kinds" of being, distinguishable independently of fixation.

This presupposition does not survive what was established in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§3–§5). If the belonging of an object to a world is the result of fixation and not a property of its own, then the division into "material" and "ideal" is not a discovery of two kinds of being but a result of the same operation. Matter and idea turn out not to be two "substances" but two regimes of fixation, and the boundary between them is established in the act of distinction, not given "in nature as such."

Hence an ironic but precise twist: we thought that "matter" was one thing and "idea" another. It turned out that these are not two objects but two ways in which something becomes determinate. The words remain, but what they denoted has collapsed.

2.2 What this does not mean

It does not mean that matter "does not exist" or that ideas "do not exist." Such an assertion would be the same classification, merely with a negative sign.

It does not mean that the distinction between the material and the ideal is meaningless. It functions as an operational distinction in concrete fixations.

It does not mean that we already know what "matter" and "idea" are. On the contrary: precisely because we do not know them, the former concepts are unsuitable.

The claim is strictly minimal: the words "matter" and "idea" do not denote two substances. Everything beyond this requires a new agreement about concepts, which is not concluded here.

On the status of the formula. This assertion is negative: it suspends the former usage of the words but does not provide a new one. It cannot be used as a positive definition ("matter is…," "idea is…")—neither in this text nor in later exposition. Positive redefinition is the task of the next step, and it does not follow automatically from Thesis 2. If the formula "matter is a regime of fixation…" occurs in further exposition, it should be read as indicating a direction, not as a result of this thesis.

2.3 What follows from this

If concepts do not do their work, they cannot simply be discarded: they are used, entire domains of inquiry depend on them. Hence work lies ahead that may be called redefinition: to invest these words with new meaning before using them again.

This is not a return to the old concepts and not a rejection of them. It is a recognition that they are not yet ready for use—like a tool that has broken and requires repair, not like one that can still be used.

Concretely, this means:

Direction, not definition. The points below are not definitions and not a positive description of what matter and idea "are." They fix the direction in which a definition could be constructed, and the limits of applicability within which the old words can still be used. Thesis 2 remains strictly negative: it suspends the former usage but does not establish a new usage. The formulas "can mean only…" are to be read as "can mean only under the condition of a description that is not given here."

- "Matter" can no longer mean "the stuff of which everything is made." It can mean only a certain regime of fixation, with its rules, medium, and boundaries. What exactly this regime is remains a question requiring description, not positing.
- "Idea" can no longer mean "that which exists elsewhere." It can mean only another regime of fixation, with different rules, a different medium, and different boundaries. And this regime, too, requires description.
- The boundary between them can no longer be thought of as an impenetrable wall. It is operational: established in fixation and capable of being re-established.

The direction of description is already indicated. The regime intuitively called "material" must be described in terms of its rules (causality, locality, conservation), its medium (mass, field, spacetime), and its boundaries (the Planck scale, the speed of light). The regime intuitively called "ideal": through its rules (logical consequence, semantic relations), its medium (sign, meaning), and its boundaries (incompleteness, undefinability). This is not a redefinition but an indication of how to construct one: the description of regimes is the task of the next step, and it relies on the distinction among rules, medium, and boundaries already introduced in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§2, §5, §6).

The next step must contain three elements: (1) a description of the regime intuitively called "material" through its rules, medium, and boundaries; (2) a description of the regime intuitively called "ideal" through its rules, medium, and boundaries; (3) a description of the operations of translation between them—not as a "connection between two entities" but as double fixation, in which one operation becomes determinate in two regimes. The present text fulfills none of these points; it suspends the formulation that blocked them.

Finally, a note on temporality: the present analysis is strictly synchronic. It describes the structural conditions under which regimes operate, not the diachronic processes by which they emerge, evolve, or dissolve. The question of genesis—how a new regime of fixation crystallizes from a prior state—is not ignored, but deferred. It requires a different descriptive apparatus (a grammar of operations in time) that lies beyond the scope of this negative, suspensive step.

2.4 Simplicity of the formulation

The thesis does not require special terminology to be understood. It can be conveyed without loss of sense: "we thought these were two different objects, but it turned out that the distinction lies not between objects but between ways of looking." Further, a matter of technique: which ways, in which operations, with which boundaries. (The formula is negative: it suspends the former distinction of objects but does not assert that "ways" are positively determinate entities.)

This is not a proof and not a simplification: it is an indication that the thesis is formulated at a level accessible without prior preparation. If its understanding required a special vocabulary, this would be a sign that it does not do its job: it speaks about the words "matter" and "idea" and does not create a new jargon.

3 Reinforcement: Perplexity at the Limits of Physics

The division of objects into material and ideal has no ontological basis: the words "matter" and "idea" do not denote two substances. This is not sleight of hand or wordplay. The same is indicated by the perplexity that contemporary data about the quantum world and cosmology produce, and the structure of this perplexity is the same as the structure of the suspension of container logic in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§1–§7).

3.1 What the perplexity consists in

In the quantum world. Wave and particle are not two states of one object but two ways in which it manifests itself under different conditions of fixation. Interference and localization are incompatible if the object is considered to be something that "in itself" has determinate properties. Nonlocal correlations are incompatible with the notion that connection requires spatial contact. Measurement is incompatible with the notion that observation does not change what is observed. Each of these "perplexities" is not a gap in data but a point at which standard concepts (object, property, causality, observation) cease to apply.

A crucial clarification is required here: this structural limit does not depend on the choice of a specific interpretation of quantum mechanics. In the Copenhagen interpretation, the limit manifests in the act of measurement; in the many-worlds interpretation (Everett), in the ontological status of branching and the derivation of probabilities; in Bohmian mechanics, in the nonlocality of hidden variables; in spontaneous collapse theories (GRW), in the unexplained moment of collapse. In every case, the conceptual apparatus formed for classical objects reaches the boundary of its applicability. The structure of perplexity is preserved across interpretations, changing only its localization, not its nature as a limit of the regime.

In cosmology. Dark matter and dark energy are not "substances we have not yet found" but indications that gravity on large scales behaves differently from what a theory constructed for intermediate scales predicts. The cosmological horizon is not "what we do not see because of the finite speed of light" but a boundary beyond which the concept of "there" loses its determinacy. The singularity of the Big Bang is not "the point from which everything began" but a limit beyond which the concepts of "before" and "after" have no application. The fine-tuning of constants is not "a riddle requiring explanation" but an indication that the constants themselves are conditions of fixation, not properties of the world "in itself."

This applies equally to alternative cosmological frameworks: even if modified gravity theories (such as MOND) eventually replace the hypotheses of dark matter and dark energy, the concept of "matter" in its classical sense still ceases to operate at cosmological scales, and the structure of the limit remains intact.

In both cases perplexity arises not where data are lacking but where concepts formed for intermediate scales reach the limits of their applicability.

3.2 Why this is not a case of "we simply do not yet know"

The temptation to explain perplexity by the incompleteness of knowledge is strong, but it does not survive scrutiny—not because accumulating data is guaranteed not to help but because the structure of the question here is different. If it were a matter of missing data, the rules of the regime would contain the method of solution—even if not yet realized: it would be known what kind of data would remove the perplexity. Here there is no such method: the question cannot be assembled by the rules of the regime. Empirically this is expressed in that the more precise the measurements, the sharper the paradoxes: the wave function does not "disappear" with increasing precision, it becomes more determinate as a formalism and less comprehensible as a description of "what is"; cosmological parameters are refined—and require increasingly strange entities for their explanation. But the decisive factor is not this series of cases but the structure of the question: the method of solution is not indicated.

The difference between ignorance and a limit of the regime is determined not by the intensity of the perplexity but by the structure of the question. In the case of ignorance, the rules of the regime contain the method of solution—even if not yet realized: it is known what kind of data would remove the perplexity. In the case of a limit, there is no such method: any attempt to answer within the rules either violates them or reproduces the perplexity, and therefore removal is possible only by changing the rules.

Hence three tests follow: can the question be posed without violating the rules; do the rules contain a method of solution, even one not yet realized; can one specify what would count as an answer. If the answer is "yes" to all three, this is ignorance; if "no" to at least one, this is a limit.

It is crucial that the criterion does not rest on historical induction ("it has not been removed so far, so it will not be removed"). It relies on the structure of the question: the method of solution is either indicated by the rules of the regime or it is not. The assertion "perplexity is not removed by accumulating data" in this context is not an empirical prediction but a diagnosis: by the structure of the question this is a limit, not ignorance. Therefore it cannot be refuted by reference to future data accumulation; it can be refuted only by showing that the method of solution is nonetheless indicated in the rules of the regime.

The criterion is diagnostic, not prophetic: it does not predict that perplexity will not be removed—it shows that by the structure of the question removal is possible not through adding data but through changing the rules. This is an assertion about structure, not about the future. This is sufficient to distinguish the present perplexities in quantum mechanics and cosmology from cases of ignorance without appealing to the history of science: the difference is drawn by the structure of the question, not by how past perplexities were resolved.

Clarification: falsifiability here is not empirical (not "future data will refute") but structural: the parallel is refuted not by accumulating data but by indicating that the method of solution is contained in the rules of the regime itself. This is an essential distinction: empirical falsifiability

predicts the future; structural falsifiability diagnoses the present. The text asserts the latter, not the former.

This is structurally the same as what was described in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§8) as the asymmetry of determinateness: determinateness is local, it holds in the middle of the range and fades at the boundaries. Quantum mechanics and cosmology are precisely the boundaries where the determinateness of "matter" and "object" fades. Perplexity is not a defect of these disciplines but a precise indicator that the concepts they use are inherited from a different range.

3.3 Why this is the same structure as the suspension of container logic

Container logic (§1 of *The Phenomenon of the World*) presupposes that a world is a container and an object is what lies in it, with its own properties independent of fixation. Quantum mechanics and cosmology show that this logic does not work: an object has no properties before fixation, a boundary does not separate "inside" from "outside," causality does not precede correlation.

This does not mean that quantum mechanics "confirms" the philosophy of *The Phenomenon of the World*. It means that empirical disciplines, having reached their limits, encounter the same thing as philosophical analysis that began from the other end. Both ends point to the same thing: the concepts "matter" and "idea" do not denote two substances; they denote two regimes of fixation, and the boundary between them is operational rather than ontological.

That is why perplexity in quantum mechanics and cosmology is not a curiosity and not an invitation to mysticism but carries weight: it shows that the suspension of container logic is not invented by philosophers but dictated by the structure of what we find at the limits of the accessible.

3.4 What this does not mean

It does not mean that quantum mechanics or cosmology "proved" the absence of matter. They showed that the concept of matter in its classical sense fails at their boundaries.

It does not mean that the paradoxes of quantum mechanics are "solved." They are not solved; they are redescribed as consequences of applying concepts outside the domain for which they were formed.

It does not mean that "idea" will now take the place of "matter." That would be the same classification, merely with the opposite sign.

The claim is strictly minimal: perplexity at the limits of physics has the same structure as the suspension of container logic and points to the same thing: the operational, not substantive character of the distinction between "the material" and "the ideal."

3.5 What this adds to the argument

This adds not a "proof" but consistency of two independent lines of argument. One line is phenomenological: the analysis of belonging in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§3–§5) shows that objects do not precede fixation. The other is empirical: physics at its limits discovers that

objects have no properties before measurement, that a boundary does not separate the internal from the external, and that causality does not precede correlation. Both lines converge on one point: container logic does not work.

When two independent lines converge at one point, this is not a proof in the strict sense, but it carries weight. And this weight turns the thesis from "philosophical sleight of hand" into a testable assertion—not on experience (experience here is already present) but on consistency with what we know about the world at its limits.

If so, this can be recorded as one more node: not "physics confirms ontology" but "perplexity at the limits of physics and the suspension of container logic have the same structure."

4 General Analysis of the Theses (external, autonomous)

Both theses form a coherent line of argument: the first formulates a modal assertion (the impossibility of the ontological barrier), the second, its lexical consequence (the words "matter" and "idea" do not denote two substances). The stated architecture runs from the modal to the terminological.

4.1 Logical structure

Thesis 1 is constructed as an argument from three premises: (1) the belonging of an object to a category is the result of an operation, not a property of its own; (2) boundaries between categories are established in an operation, not given independently of it; (3) a boundary not established in any operation is not a boundary. From these premises it follows that the ontological barrier—a boundary not established in any operation—cannot be fixed without ceasing to be ontological. This is not an inductive generalization ("we have not found a barrier") nor a modal consequence from the absence of an external standpoint but an analysis of the concept: the ontological barrier requires an operation that cancels it. The conclusion is correct given Premise 3: it introduces no new content beyond the framework of the ontology of fixation but depends on its operationalist condition. Without this premise the conclusion does not follow; with it, it follows analytically.

The formulation remains strictly minimal: what is claimed is not "there is a connection" but "there is nothing that would make connection impossible." The former is defensible, the latter is not. We consistently maintain this distinction as a matter of methodological discipline.

Thesis 2 is not an independent addition but a reformulation of Thesis 1 at the lexical level. This makes it derivative rather than "radical," and therefore immune to the objection "this is sleight of hand": if the ontological barrier cannot be fixed as a boundary, the words that denoted the two sides of the barrier cannot denote two substances. The logical dependence is explicitly traced.

4.2 Validity of the premises

The premises of Thesis 1 can be assessed independently of their origin. Premises (1) and (2) are widespread in contemporary philosophy: from the later Wittgenstein to social epistemology and the philosophy of science. Premise (1), moreover, is not only widespread in contemporary

philosophy but is proved by reductio (see Thesis 1, §3). Premise (3) is not a convention but an appeal to the understanding of the boundary already established in *The Phenomenon of the World* (§1–§6) as an internal condition rather than an external wall; an additional argument in its favor is given in the text itself (see Thesis 1, §3): a boundary stripped of all operational functions does none of the work that makes a boundary a boundary. That is precisely why the conclusion is not a verbal maneuver: it relies on an analysis of the concept, not on a redefinition of the word. It advances a position: the ontological barrier is neither posited nor denied: it is shown that the concept requires an operation that cancels it. The framework shares with process philosophy (Whitehead, Deleuze) the rejection of static substance and the emphasis on relational constitution. It differs in that it does not posit becoming as ontologically primary: fixation is not a flow that produces its terms but a condition under which terms acquire determinacy. The difference is not terminological: process philosophy requires a metaphysics of becoming; the ontology of fixation requires only a description of conditions. This makes the framework more parsimonious: it does not need to answer the question "what is becoming made of?" because it does not posit becoming as an entity.

4.3 Consistency with external knowledge

Reinforcement (perplexity at the limits of physics). Quantum mechanics and cosmology do indeed generate perplexity whose structure is a limit, not ignorance. This is not an interpretation but a diagnosable condition: by the structure of the question the method of solution is not indicated, and this is confirmed in that the wave function does not "disappear" as measurements become more refined; the EPR paradox is not resolved by the discovery of particles; dark energy is introduced as a parameter, not as a substance; the singularity is placed beyond the limits of the applicability of the concepts "before" and "after." Each of these cases is not a gap in data but a limit of the concepts. But the decisive factor is not this series of cases but the structure of the question: the method of solution is not indicated. We put it thus: perplexity arises where concepts formed for intermediate scales reach the limits of applicability.

We do not say "physics confirms philosophy." But we say something weaker and more reliable: the structure of perplexity is the same as the structure of the suspension of container logic. This is an assertion about consistency, not about proof.

A clarification on the status of falsifiability here. The assertion that perplexity at the limits of physics has the same structure as the suspension of container logic is not empirically falsifiable in the sense of "future data will refute it." It is structurally falsifiable: the parallel would be refuted if one could show that the method of solution is nonetheless contained in the rules of the regime itself. This is not a prediction about the future but a diagnosis of the present structure. Similarly, Gödel-likeness (cf. §10 of *The Phenomenon of the World*) is not an empirical hypothesis but a structural necessity: any sufficiently complex formal system cannot justify its own axioms from within. If physics resolves current paradoxes, it will not abolish Gödel-likeness but relocate the blind spot. The framework is not unfalsifiable; it is falsifiable in a different register—not by accumulating data but by showing that the structure of the question is different from what is claimed.

Moreover, it is falsifiable: if the rules of the regime indicated a method of solution, the parallel would weaken. This thesis is scientific in the strict sense, since it is falsifiable, though not by reference to future data accumulation but by indicating the structure of the question.

Here it is important to distinguish the status of the two theses. Thesis 1 is categorical: it follows from an analysis of the concept and cannot be refuted by data. This does not make it unscientific: claims of this kind (for example, "there is no round square") are not falsifiable by data, but they make no empirical claim either. The reinforcement is empirically sensitive: it relies on the observable state of physics and is therefore falsifiable. If the rules of the regime indicated a method of solution, the parallel would weaken. Confusing these statuses weakens both: Thesis 1 begins to look like an empirical generalization, which it is not, and the reinforcement like a categorical assertion that cannot be refuted.

4.4 Productivity

The theses offer not a "solution" to the mind–body problem but a reformulation: "in what operations is the boundary established, and where does it cease to work." This does not cancel the problem but changes its register, and it is precisely such changes of register that have historically proved productive (cf. the transition from "what is heat" to "how is heat transfer described"). Productivity here is not merely asserted but follows from the structure: the theses make possible a description of the mechanisms of transition without requiring a prior decision about the "nature" of matter and idea.

4.5 Limitations

Our theses do not provide a positive description of the mechanism of transition between "the material" and "the ideal." The sketch of double fixation for the case of qualia (see Thesis 1, §5) shows how the mechanism could work but does not develop it fully: that would require a separate study of the operations of the phenomenal regime. This is the limit of what is claimed: we are aware of it and state it.

The reinforcement relies on an interpretation of quantum mechanics and cosmology which, although widely accepted (perplexity as a consequence of the limits of concepts), is not the only one. This does not weaken our thesis but requires caution in formulation: "the structure of perplexity is the same," not "physics proves." The reinforcement does not assert that the paradoxes will not be removed by accumulating data; it asserts that by the structure of the question they belong to the limit, not to ignorance. This is a diagnosis, not a prediction.

The concepts "matter" and "idea" remain indeterminate in a positive sense. The theses function as negative (what these words do not denote), not as positive (what they do denote). In particular, Thesis 2 cannot be used as a basis for a positive definition ("matter is a regime of fixation X"): it only suspends the former usage and indicates the direction in which a definition could be constructed. This limitation is not a gap but a consequence of the status of the formula.

The strength of Thesis 1 lies in its categorical status: it is not refutable by data, since it is not an empirical assertion. The strength of the reinforcement lies in its testability: it is refutable by

indicating that the method of solution is nonetheless indicated in the rules of the regime, and this makes it scientific in the strict sense.

A final clarification on the status of the framework itself. The ontology of fixation, including Gödel-likeness, is not a rhetorical shield that makes the framework immune to criticism. It is a structural condition of any distinction conducted from within. The framework acknowledges that it is itself a distinction subject to the same limits it describes: it has a solid core (the operational definition of fixation, the distinction between limit and blind spot) and an open periphery (the positive description of operations, the genesis of regimes, the mechanism of translation). This is not a defect but a consequence of self-applicability. The framework is falsifiable in the following sense: if one could construct a closed system that fully justifies itself from within without remainder, Gödel-likeness would be refuted. But this is mathematically impossible. Therefore the framework is not unfalsifiable; it is falsifiable in a register that is structural rather than empirical.

Appendix. Internal Analysis of the Theses (for readers familiar with Ontology Lab)

The internal analysis, relying on the concepts of Ontology Lab (Bindability, the metric of ontological complexity, the threshold of qualitative leap, inter/aut-aspects of the boundary, double fixation), is provided in the Appendix. It is not mandatory for understanding the theses: the external analysis preceding it is self-contained. The Appendix is addressed to those familiar with previous works and who wish to see how the theses relate to previously introduced concepts.

1. **Thesis 1 already functioned in Ontology Lab as a result, not as an assumption.** In the working paper on the dialectic of Bindability it is shown that every act of establishing control generates a counter-dependence—the controller himself becomes dependent on what he controls. This is not a metaphor but a structural conclusion: there is no one-sided control. It follows that a one-sided, impenetrable boundary does not exist either: a boundary established in an act thereby includes the one who establishes it in the relation. Thesis 1 is not a new claim but a generalization of this result to the case of "matter/thought."

2. **Thesis 1 is supported by the distinction between limit and blind spot.** In *The Phenomenon of the World* (§6) a distinction was introduced: the limit is fixed as a condition (it is known where the rules are exhausted), the blind spot is not fixed (the question cannot be assembled from the means of the world). Applied to the barrier between matter and thought, this gives a precise formulation: one could assert an impenetrable barrier only as a limit, that is, with an indication of exactly where it runs and under what conditions. But such an indication requires means that fixation lacks: the barrier would be a blind spot, and a blind spot cannot be fixed as a barrier. This does not weaken Thesis 1 but provides internal support for it: it follows from the structure of the boundary described in §6.

3. **Thesis 2 is supported by the distinction between inter- and aut-aspects of the boundary.** In Ontology Lab the boundary is described as an active zone of translation with two aspects: inter (connection between regimes) and aut (internal otherness of the regime and the point of external connection). Applied to "matter" and "idea," this means: the

boundary between them is neither purely external (a wall) nor purely internal (a property of one regime). It is an operation in which both aspects are combined. It follows that the words "matter" and "idea" cannot denote two sides of the barrier: the barrier as such is not fixed; there is an operation in which the boundary is established and crossed. This is not an analogy but an application of the distinction introduced above.

4. **The reinforcement is supported by the metric of ontological complexity and the threshold of qualitative leap.** In Ontology Lab two quantities are introduced: the metric of ontological complexity (Propertyness) and the threshold of qualitative leap (Salience)—a measure of transition intensity beyond which a system passes to a new state. Applied to perplexity at the limits of physics, this gives an operational description: paradoxes arise not where data are lacking but where fixation approaches a threshold beyond which its resources are exhausted. This is not an interpretation but an application of the metric: perplexity is an indicator of approaching the threshold, not a gap in data.

5. **Thesis 2 is supported by the distinction of worlds as regimes and local systems of rules.** In *The Phenomenon of the World* (§2) a distinction was introduced: a world is a regime containing systems of rules; a local system of rules is an object or process within a regime. Applied to "matter" and "idea," this means: they are neither two regimes nor two systems of rules but two modes of fixation within a single field. Hence the precise formulation of Thesis 2: the words "matter" and "idea" do not denote two substances because substances would require two regimes, whereas there is only one regime.

6. **Both theses are supported by the principle of self-application.** In Ontology Lab the distinction drawn in the text is subject to the same conditions as any fixation: it has rules, a medium, and limits of applicability; it has a solid core and an open periphery. Applied to the theses, this means: they do not claim to solve completely the mind–body problem but register what has been distinguished. This does not weaken them but indicates their status: they are a step, not an answer. And this is consistent with the reinforcement: perplexity at the limits of physics has the same structure as the distinction drawn in the text: a solid core and an open periphery.

7. **Both theses are consistent with the previously introduced description of transition between regimes.** In Ontology Lab transition is described as double fixation: one operation becomes determinate in two regimes simultaneously, without any transfer of substrate. Applied to "matter" and "idea," this gives a positive sketch (not a claim but an indication of direction): what we call "the material" and "the ideal" can be described as two fixations of one operation, not as two substances between which a connection must be sought. Here "one operation" is a name for the mutual limitation of two fixations, not for a third thing lying behind them (cf. Thesis 1, §5, sketch of qualia). This does not solve the problem but renders its formulation compatible with the mechanism described above.

AI Use Disclosure

During the preparation of this work, the author used AI tools exclusively for stylistic and technical editing to improve readability. After using these tools, the output was carefully reviewed, edited, and verified by the author, who takes full responsibility for the conceptual architecture, analysis, and final content of the paper.

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